

Chapter 153_2 - Curtain Fall

"Quickly!" Chu Qingqiu tried to rise, but was pressed down by Ning Fuyi, who silently shook her head.

"It's too late." She smiled miserably.

Tianrui had used almost half of his cultivation to sew the Mountain-River Diagram, precisely to ensure that even if his scheme failed and he died, these six realms would still be destroyed.

Mutual destruction.

Outside Penglai¹, the fighting had ceased. The surviving immortals and demons all poured into Penglai, supporting their sect masters, while more people stood silently with neither joy nor sorrow on their faces.

Ning Fuyi looked around and saw Jiang Li, also covered in blood, pushing through the crowd and collapsing beneath the Mountain-River Diagram, holding Black Scales² who had fallen at some unknown time, weeping.

She saw the disciples of Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate³ standing behind them, silently wiping away tears. She saw Liu Wenzhu holding the unconscious Hua Feihua⁴ with one hand while supporting the blood-covered Elder Pingyao with the other, sobbing at her.

She saw Xi Que⁵ and Han Ya⁶ kneeling beside her, and Jiuying⁷ standing behind the crowd with an injured leg, gazing at the sky, lost in thought.

There were some figures she did not see.

Ning Fuyi suddenly released her grip, entrusting the powerless Chu Qingqiu to Han Ya and ordering her to take good care of her.

"Ning Fuyi, where are you going?" Chu Qingqiu hastily grabbed her sleeve, but Ning Fuyi moved quickly, and the wet sleeve slipped through her fingertips.

"Chu Qingqiu, if this time it's me who saves all living beings, would you be proud of me?" Ning Fuyi grinned with red lips, her phoenix eyes blazing in the heavy rain.

"No, no..." Chu Qingqiu lunged forward to pull her back, but Han Ya gritted her teeth and held her tight, causing her to grasp at empty air.

"No, Ning Fuyi, don't..." For the first time, Chu Qingqiu cried so helplessly. Half of her body had sunk into the muddy water, no longer maintaining the bearing of an immortal.

"Ning Fuyi!" Liu Wenzhu also sensed something was wrong. She dropped Hua Feihua and Elder Pingyao, lifting her legs to run toward her, but was tripped by a mass of black energy and fell to her knees with a splash.

"Jiuying, you won't stop me, will you?" Ning Fuyi said softly.

Jiuying's hand, which had been reaching toward her, paused, then dropped. Her crimson lips curved upward as she shrugged at Ning Fuyi.

"Jiuying, stop her! Jiuying, please, I beg you to stop her..."

No one had ever seen Chu Qingqiu lose composure, much less seen her plead so desperately. Her beautiful face was covered with tears, nearly driven to madness. Han Ya practically threw her entire body weight onto her to prevent her from breaking free.

Chu Qingqiu had always been indifferent to life and death throughout her life. Only now did she realize that dying for all living beings wasn't difficult for her.

Watching helplessly as one's beloved departed - that was the most difficult thing in the world.

Ning Fuyi smiled like clouds about to dissipate. She suddenly turned around and used her fingertips, dipped in immortal power, to draw complex formations on the ground stroke by stroke.

The formation she had drawn many, many times in her previous life - even though she hadn't thought about it in this life, when she picked up the brush again, it still flowed like water.

The Reincarnation Array.

"Mother, protect me." Ning Fuyi said softly, then took one last look at Chu Qingqiu before turning back to add the final stroke.

Sure enough, without needing to activate the formation, her hair suddenly stood on end, and the most powerful rolling thunder in the world came from overhead.

She was a demon. A demon who created the Reincarnation Array should receive harsher punishment than gods, shouldn't she? Ning Fuyi looked up at the rain and smiled. That thunder lived up to expectations, shaking her heart and lungs with pain.

Farewell, friends. Farewell, mountains, rivers, lakes, and seas. Farewell to this place that didn't seem so terrible after all.

Farewell, Chu Qingqiu.

Behind her, Chu Qingqiu screamed until her throat bled. Ning Fuyi didn't dare look back. She pushed off with her toes, transforming into flowing light as she rushed toward the heavenly thunder that had already gathered to the size of the sun above her head.

The heavenly thunder connected to chaos. If she died and approached the Mountain-River Diagram before the thunder struck, perhaps she could drag the diagram into chaos and save all living beings who were affected by it.

This time, she truly wanted to protect.

Wind and rain crackled past her ears. Perhaps because she was getting closer to the lightning, she didn't feel cold but instead felt burning hot all over.

The moment she made contact with the heavenly thunder, she closed her eyes with tears. The dazzling light penetrated her skin, instantly burning her eyes to smoke. Yet in that instant, she saw the rustling fallen leaves of countless mountains.

She saw wind brushing through forests, the sea of trees rolling like tides, several birds playfully stringing together and soaring thousands of miles through the sky.

She saw such a beautiful mortal world.

Footnotes:

¹ **Penglai (蓬莱)** - A mystical realm in Chinese mythology, often associated with immortals and paradise.

² **Black Scales (黑鳞)** - A character name, likely referring to someone with draconic or serpentine characteristics.

³ **Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate (云际山门)** - The name of Ning Fuyi's sect/school.

⁴ **Hua Feihua (花非花)** - A character name literally meaning "flower that is not a flower."

⁵ **Xi Que (喜鹊)** - Literally means "magpie," likely a character name or code name.

⁶ **Han Ya (寒鸦)** - Literally means "cold crow," likely a character name or code name.

⁷ **Jiuying (九婴)** - A nine-headed mythical beast, or in this context, a character who may be related to or transformed from such a creature.